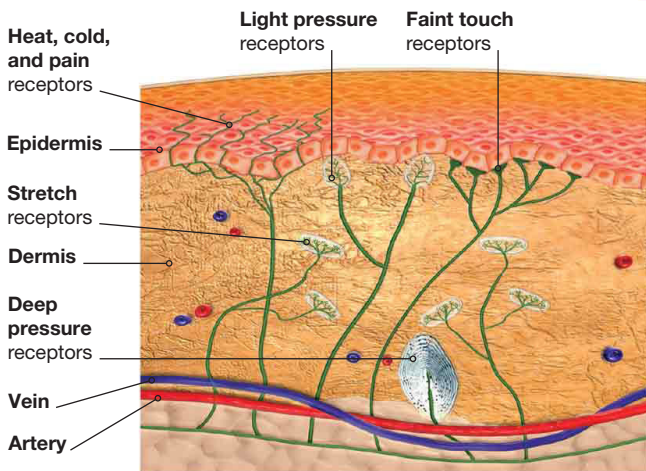


Touching

The skin contains touch sensors that allow us to experience the softness of an animal's fur, the iciness of a cold swim, and much more. These skin sensors send signals to the brain, which gives us a “touch picture” of our surroundings.

Skin receptors

This cross-section through the skin shows the different types of touch sensor. Most are found in the dermis, the skin's lower layer. The nerve endings that detect heat, cold, and pain may extend into the epidermis, the skin's outer layer.



TYPES OF TOUCH

These images show the different types of touch sensation that are detected by the skin. There is also a sixth type—pain.



Cold and heat



Light pressure